When Philly PD Fails You

They didn't come. Here's who will.

The suffering was real. The outcome is useful. Given away free.

Standing up for your rights is not snitching. It is citizenship. You are a United States citizen. Human decency is owed to you by law, not by permission.

1. Skip Your District — Call State Police

Pennsylvania State Police, Troop K, Philadelphia barracks. **2201 Belmont Avenue**. Phone: **215-452-5216**.

They cover Philadelphia County independently of the Philadelphia Police Department. You do not call your district back. You call them. They handle everything from traffic disputes to noise ordinances to situations your local precinct sat on.

2. File Where It Lands — CPOC

Citizens Police Oversight Commission. This is the city's civilian oversight body, not Internal Affairs.

- Phone: **215-685-0891**
- Email: CPOC@phila.gov
- Address: 2401 Walnut Street, Suite 602

They take your complaint, review it, and forward it to PPD's Internal Affairs Division. They can also sit in on interviews with you and monitor the investigation.

3. Private Criminal Complaint (No Police Report Needed)

Under Pennsylvania Rule of Criminal Procedure 506, any civilian can submit a criminal case directly to the court. You do not need a police report. You do not need police approval.

- **1425 Arch Street, 4th Floor**
- Phone: **215-686-9848**

Bring the accused's full name and address, any district control number you already have, and your documentation. Harassment, terroristic threats, criminal mischief, and assault between neighbors or family members all qualify. Approved cases go to the Stout Center at 1301 Filbert Street.

4. What the Law Protects

Harassment — Title 18, Section 2709. A course of conduct with no legitimate purpose: repeated contact at inconvenient hours, anonymous communication, threatening or obscene language, following someone in public. Third-degree misdemeanor for communication-based offenses.

Cyber harassment of a child — Title 18, Section 2709(a.1). Electronic messages targeting a minor's appearance, health, or safety.

Noise ordinance. Quiet hours 9:00 PM to 8:00 AM. Sound audible past 100 feet is a violation. First fine: $100–$300. File through 311 or the Philly 311 app.

Parental rights — Title 18, Section 509. A parent may use reasonable force to safeguard or promote a child's welfare, including preventing or punishing misconduct, as long as it does not create substantial risk of death, serious injury, disfigurement, extreme pain, or mental distress.

Parental rights — Title 23, Section 6304. Reasonable force for supervision, control, and safety is explicitly excluded from the definition of child abuse. You are not a criminal for holding a boundary.

5. Cease and Desist — Civilian Version

You do not need a lawyer to send one. Write it: your name, their name, the specific conduct, the demand to stop immediately, and the statement that continued conduct becomes evidence of intent. Send it certified mail with return receipt. That green card is your proof they were notified. Keep a copy of everything.

6. Free Legal Backup

• **Community Legal Services** — 215-981-3700. New clients by phone only. Expanded intake four days a week. Walk-ins Tuesdays and Thursdays 9 AM–12 PM at 1424 Chestnut Street. Family hotline for DHS cases: 215-981-3765.
• **Philly Tenant Hotline** — 267-443-2500
• Income limit: 125% of federal poverty (~$34,000 for a family of three in 2026).
• Protection from Abuse (PFA) orders can be filed yourself at the courthouse.

Documentation That Wins

One chronology. Date, time, location, witness names, exact conduct, every call you made and who you spoke to. Original video files backed up — never screenshots alone. A clean log plus footage persuades prosecutors in a way verbal descriptions never match.

Founder Note

I spent fifty-nine nights learning this the hard way so you don't have to. Fifteen calls in twenty-four hours. Three visits. A sergeant who wouldn't come. A neighbor who looked me in the face and lied. I was exhausted. I was a mother alone with a four-year-old. And I nearly broke before I found the back door.

This guide is that back door — free, because when your child's safety is on the line, twenty dollars is the difference between knowing and not knowing. You are not a byproduct of someone else's failure to act. You have rights. Use them.

— Tiny